

REQUEST FOR EMPANELMENT

Empanelment of Digital Marketing Support Firms / Agencies / Experts

Issuing Entity	Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH)
Document Ref No	RTIH-AMVT/RFE/2026/005A
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Submission Mode	Single Google Form response with structured uploads
Application Window	Open on a rolling basis
Review Cycle	Applications will ordinarily be reviewed once every quarter





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1. Background and Purpose

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH) invites applications from eligible digital marketing agencies, branding studios, content firms, website and CRM implementation partners, multimedia production firms, multidisciplinary advisory LLPs / companies, and other legally eligible professional entities for empanelment on a non-exclusive basis to provide startup-facing digital marketing and digital enablement support for RTIH and its ecosystem.

The empanelled panel is intended to help startups establish a credible digital presence and access structured support across foundational digital assets, content, communication design, lead-capture systems, and growth-oriented marketing support. RTIH aims to make the offering easier for startups to understand and easier for RTIH to compare by using standard service definitions, mandatory commercial heads, and RTIH-owned package references.

This empanelment is designed to support both fixed-scope early-stage requirements and startup-specific bespoke assignments. Startups may have different goals such as brand awareness, lead generation, direct sales, founder branding, investor visibility, recruitment support, or launch readiness. Accordingly, RTIH may use the panel for component-wise assignments, package-based engagements, or startup-specific briefs.

2. Rolling Application and Review Cycle

Milestone	Date / Remarks
Release of RFE	08 Jun 2026
Application Mode	Rolling / open call
Submission Channel	RTIH Google Form with structured uploads
Review Frequency	Applications will ordinarily be reviewed once every quarter
Review Cut-offs	RTIH may adopt quarterly cut-off dates for administrative convenience and may notify the current applicable cut-off on the website / Google Form / related communication
Clarifications	May be submitted on a rolling basis to proposals@rtih.co.in
Communication of Empanelment	RTIH may communicate empanelment outcomes after each review cycle or as otherwise determined
Applications received after a review cut-off	May be considered in the next review cycle



3. Nature of Empanelment

- The empanelment is non-exclusive.
- RTIH may empanel one or more firms / experts, including multidisciplinary or specialist providers.
- Assignments may be issued from time to time based on requirement, specialization, startup-stage fit, sector relevance, independence, responsiveness, timelines, quality, past performance, and commercial reasonableness.
- RTIH may allocate integrated package-based assignments or separate workstreams such as branding, photography, reels, website setup, landing pages, CRM setup, content creation, reporting, or paid media support.
- Empanelment shall not guarantee any minimum number of assignments, minimum fee, or preferred status.
- RTIH may route some engagements directly through RTIH, while others may arise from startup demand under RTIH programmes or ecosystem support processes.

4. Indicative Scope of Services

- Branding support, including light discovery, positioning support, logo systems, basic brand guidelines, and startup-facing collateral.
- Photo and video production support, including product, founder, team, workplace, pitch, or storytelling-oriented shoots and edits.
- Website setup on no-code or low-code CMS platforms such as WordPress, Webflow, Shopify, or equivalent, with startup ownership and full admin access.
- Landing page design and implementation for product launches, campaigns, lead capture, or startup information pages.
- Social media profile setup and optimisation across relevant startup-facing platforms.
- CRM setup and integration, including lead capture from web and social channels and basic workflow automation.
- Presentation formatting, pitch deck polishing, and startup communication design support.
- Unit-based content creation, including reels, posts, blogs, articles, captions, and copywriting.
- Monthly reporting and review support.
- Optional startup-specific bespoke services such as ongoing social media management, paid media management, campaign execution, SEO, automation, founder advisory, or workshops.



5. Eligibility Criteria

- Applicants should be an agency, studio, firm, LLP, company, multidisciplinary professional services entity, or other legally valid professional services provider with authority to render the proposed services.
- Minimum 3 years of relevant experience is required.
- Demonstrable experience in startup, MSME, founder-brand, product, service-business, or early-stage digital enablement assignments is strongly preferred.
- Applicants may apply as multidisciplinary providers or as specialists; however, they should clearly identify the service categories for which they seek empanelment.
- Applicants proposing website / CRM / account-setup services should be capable of ensuring complete startup ownership or orderly handover of all relevant admin access, credentials, editable files, and documentation.
- Applicant should be capable of issuing GST invoice where applicable.
- Applicant should not be blacklisted by any government department, PSU, statutory body, or court order at the time of submission.
- Applicant must be willing to comply with RTIH requirements on confidentiality, conflict of interest, access-control, data handling, and escalation.

6. Information to be Submitted

- Firm profile, legal constitution, office locations, SPOC details, and service coverage.
- Profile of key professionals proposed for branding, content, design, web / tech, CRM / automation, performance marketing, and client servicing workstreams.
- Summary of relevant assignments, preferably including startup, MSME, founder, product, or early-stage brand-building work.
- Relevant work samples, case studies, or public portfolio links.
- Typical monthly capacity and average turnaround times for standard and urgent assignments.
- Approach note on discovery, workflow, approvals, quality review, editable-file handover, admin-access transfer, and post-delivery support boundaries.
- References or contactable client names, where shareable.
- Commercial submission in the RTIH-prescribed format, including standard quotable items, paid-media fee models, and RTIH package quotes.



7. Submission Structure and Method

Applications shall be submitted through the RTIH Google Form link published on the website. The form and uploads should be structured as follows:

- Part A – Technical / Capability Submission: firm profile, registrations, team details, relevant experience, work samples, case studies, sector strengths, workflow, handover safeguards, references, and relevant uploads.
- Part B – Commercial Submission: filled rate card for the standard service basket, quotes for RTIH package references, paid-media fee models, assumptions regarding GST and pass-through costs, and any optional or special-case services.

RTIH may review technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. This separation is for screening convenience and does not require a formal two-envelope tender process.

All uploaded files should clearly identify the applicant firm and document type in the filename (for example: FirmName_Profile.pdf, FirmName_CaseStudies.pdf, FirmName_CommercialRateCard.pdf, FirmName_Declaration.pdf).

Commercial Schedule

All quotes shall clearly separate professional fees from GST, platform / media spends, domain or hosting charges, travel, premium software costs, stock assets, influencer payouts, printing, or any other third-party / pass-through costs.

S No	Service Item	Unit for Quote	Quote Required
DM1	Branding package	Complete package	Mandatory
DM2	Product photography	Per final edited photo and / or per shoot day	Mandatory
DM3	Founder / team photography	Per final edited photo and / or per shoot day	Mandatory
DM4	Reel / short-form video	Per final reel and / or per shoot day	Mandatory
DM5	Website setup (no-code / low-code CMS)	Complete setup	Mandatory
DM6	Landing page	Per page	Mandatory
DM7	Social media profile setup and optimisation	Complete setup	Mandatory
DM8	CRM setup and integration	Complete setup	Mandatory



S No	Service Item	Unit for Quote	Quote Required
DM9	Presentation formatting / pitch deck editing	Per slide and / or complete deck	Mandatory
DM10	Blog / article writing	Per word and / or per article	Mandatory
DM11	Social media copywriting	Per post	Mandatory
DM12	Social media creative design (static / carousel)	Per creative / per carousel set	Mandatory
DM13	Monthly reporting / dashboard	Per month	Mandatory
DM14	Paid media management - flat monthly management fee (excluding ad spend)	Per month	Mandatory or mark Not Offered
DM15	Paid media management - percentage-of-spend fee (excluding ad spend)	Percentage of spend	Mandatory or mark Not Offered
DM16	Paid media management - optional spend-band pricing sheet	State basis / upload sheet	Optional but recommended
DM17	Launch Package quote	Per package / per month (state basis)	Mandatory or mark Not Offered
DM18	Growth Package quote	Per package / per month (state basis)	Mandatory or mark Not Offered
DM19	Scale Package quote	Per package / per month (state basis)	Mandatory or mark Not Offered
DM20	Startup-specific bespoke services proposed by bidder	Specify unit	Optional

Submission Checklist

Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part A - Firm profile, service coverage, and contact details	Yes	In Google Form and / or uploaded profile deck
Part A - Registration proof and profile of key professionals	Yes	Registration / GST / PAN / key team details as applicable



Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part A - Relevant work samples / portfolio links / public references	Yes	Public or non-confidential examples are sufficient
Part A - Experience note / client examples relevant to startups or MSMEs	Yes	3-10 examples may be provided
Part A - Capability note on workflow, approvals, quality checks, handover, and admin-access approach	Yes	1-4 pages recommended
Part A - References / client testimonials, where shareable	No	Optional but recommended
Part A - Conflict of interest and no-blacklisting declaration	Yes	Signed on letterhead
Part B - Filled, signed and stamped commercial rate card in prescribed format	Yes	Professional fees separate from GST / pass-through costs
Part B - Package quote assumptions sheet, if any	No	Optional but recommended
Public listing consent, logo, and short public profile	No	Only if the bidder wants RTIH to showcase the firm publicly

8. Evaluation Approach

- Eligibility and completeness of submission.
- Depth and relevance of digital marketing and digital enablement experience, especially in startup, MSME, founder, or early-stage contexts.
- Quality and relevance of case studies, portfolio, and work samples.
- Team capability, senior oversight, and client-servicing structure.
- Ability to work with early-stage startups and translate ambiguous goals into practical scopes.
- Sector relevance or domain strengths, where applicable.
- References, workflow maturity, quality checks, handover discipline, and access-transfer safeguards.
- Turnaround commitments, responsiveness, and commercial reasonableness.
- Pricing shall be considered, but shall not be the sole or primary determinant of empanelment.





9. Optional Public Listing of Empanelled Firms

RTIH may choose to showcase consenting empanelled firms on its website, decks, or ecosystem materials for discoverability. Applicants may opt in separately for such listing.

- The bidder may provide firm logo, website / LinkedIn link, office locations, sector strengths, and a short public profile for such listing.
- Public display by RTIH shall be optional and subject to explicit bidder consent.
- Such listing shall not amount to endorsement, ranking, preferred partner status, exclusivity, or guarantee of work allocation.

10. Key Terms & General Provisions

Proposal Validity

All submissions made in response to this RFE shall remain valid and binding for a period of 90 days from the date of submission, unless a longer validity is expressly stated by the applicant.

Nature of Empanelment and No Work Guarantee

This RFE is being issued for the purpose of non-exclusive empanelment of suitable professional firms. Empanelment shall not create any exclusive right, preferred status, minimum business assurance, or guaranteed work allocation in favour of any empanelled firm.

Empanelment Period

Unless otherwise specified by RTIH, empanelment under this RFE shall remain valid for a period of two (2) years from the date of empanelment, unless extended, suspended, or terminated earlier by RTIH.

Work Allocation and Confirmation of Capacity

RTIH may allocate assignments individually or in batches. Before issuing any specific assignment, RTIH may seek confirmation of availability, stage-fit, independence, team availability, acceptance of timelines, and applicability of quoted rates or packages.





Technical and Commercial Review

RTIH may assess technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. RTIH is not bound to adopt a lowest-price-only approach.

Confidentiality

Applicants and empanelled firms shall treat all non-public startup information, assets, access credentials, analytics, customer information, commercial records, and other materials shared by RTIH or startups in connection with this RFE or any assignment as confidential and shall not disclose or use the same except for the relevant engagement.

Conflict of Interest

Applicants must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest, including any personal, professional, financial, advisory, investor, founder, or counterparty relationship that may impair, or appear to impair, their independence or objectivity in relation to RTIH or any startup / process under review.

Accuracy of Information / Misrepresentation

If at any stage an applicant is found to have misrepresented facts, concealed material information, submitted false documents, or otherwise acted in a fraudulent, corrupt, or unfair manner, RTIH may reject the application, cancel empanelment, withdraw any work allocation, or take such other action as it deems appropriate, without liability.

Subcontracting

No empanelled firm shall subcontract the whole or any material part of an assignment issued by RTIH without prior written approval of RTIH. Where such approval is granted, the empanelled firm shall remain fully responsible for quality, timeliness, compliance, confidentiality, and conduct of the services.

Governing Law and Jurisdiction

This RFE and any empanelment arising from it shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India. Courts at Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh shall have exclusive jurisdiction.





RTIH

Non-Binding Nature of RFE

No binding relationship, contractual obligation, or enforceable rights shall arise from this RFE or empanelment unless and until a separate written work order or engagement letter is issued by RTIH.



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Annexure 1: Minimum Scope Inclusions for Mandatory Commercial Items

DM1 Branding package must include:

- light discovery conversation or structured input capture from startup team
- brand positioning summary or messaging note appropriate to the startup stage
- logo suite and basic visual system
- basic usage sheet / brand guideline note
- editable files and startup handover
- one round of routine revision within agreed scope

DM4 Reel / short-form video must include at a minimum:

- clear statement whether the quote assumes founder-supplied raw footage, agency-shot footage, or either
- editing of one reel / short-form video in the quoted unit
- basic captions / text overlays where relevant
- music / asset assumptions clearly stated
- one round of routine revision within agreed scope

DM5 Website setup must include:

- agreed information architecture and page structure
- basic copy placement or imported copy based on startup inputs
- mobile-responsive setup on an agreed platform
- startup ownership / admin handover at completion
- basic documentation or handover note

DM8 CRM setup and integration must include:

- basic lead-capture structure and workflow setup
- integration with agreed forms / channels within quoted scope
- user handover and startup access
- basic explanation of workflow logic or setup note

DM13 Monthly reporting must include:

- metric summary in a usable reporting format
- brief commentary on activity performed and next-step observations
- at least one review touchpoint if included in the quoted model





Annexure 2: Minimum Deliverable Definitions for Common Units

For purposes of commercial comparison, the following minimum deliverable definitions shall apply unless the applicant clearly states a superior inclusion. Applicants may include more, but not less, without clearly flagging exclusions.

Reel / short-form video

- one final edited vertical-format video output
- basic edit assembly, captions / text overlays where relevant, and export-ready file
- state whether ideation, scripting, shoot planning, voice-over, thumbnail, posting, and asset sourcing are included or excluded

Social media post / creative

- one final designed creative in agreed dimensions
- state whether copywriting, resizing, carousel formatting, source file handover, and posting are included or excluded

Blog / article

- one final written piece in the quoted word range or stated article length
- state whether research depth, SEO optimisation, graphics, upload / CMS publishing, and revisions are included or excluded

Landing page

- one live or handover-ready page with agreed sections
- state whether copywriting, form integration, analytics setup, mobile optimisation, and A/B testing are included or excluded

Monthly report

- reporting summary for the agreed month or period
- state whether dashboard access, insights, review call, and action recommendations are included or excluded

Content calendar

- calendar of proposed content topics / formats for the agreed period
- state whether publishing schedule, hashtags, hooks, scripts, and approval workflow are included or excluded



Annexure 3: RTIH Standard Startup Packages for Quotation Reference

Applicants are requested to quote against the following RTIH-owned reference packages as applicable. These package references are intended to make startup-facing offerings easier to understand and compare. Agencies may clearly state assumptions, inclusions, exclusions, timelines, and startup dependencies.

Launch Package – for very early-stage startups

- indicatively includes basic discovery, positioning support, profile setup, one light web presence output, and foundational communication assets
- intended use cases may include first digital presence, founder introduction, investor-readiness basics, or early launch readiness
- quote should state whether photography, reel creation, CRM setup, or deck polishing are included

Growth Package – for startups seeking structured outreach

- indicatively includes recurring content support, lead-generation enablers, and monthly reporting / review
- intended use cases may include visibility, inbound lead generation, founder-brand support, or product outreach
- quote should state whether ad management, landing pages, and CRM workflows are included

Scale Package – for startups with more advanced needs

- indicatively includes multi-channel execution support, analytics discipline, and optimisation-oriented workstreams
- intended use cases may include paid campaigns, performance review, SEO / automation layers, or broader digital growth management
- quote should state whether media strategy, ad operations, automation, and reporting cadence are included



Annexure 4: Indicative Access, Handover and Responsibility Matrix

- Startup / relevant entity: provides brand inputs, product / service information, founder details, raw assets, approvals, access credentials where necessary, and timely feedback required for the relevant assignment.
- Empanelled firm: undertakes the work within scope, flags dependencies, maintains version discipline, prepares outputs, and provides orderly handover of editable files, exports, credentials, and setup notes as applicable.
- RTIH: facilitates process coordination for RTIH-routed matters, clarifies scope context where required, and supports escalation if needed; RTIH does not assume responsibility for delayed startup inputs or approvals unless expressly agreed.

